

XP also came in Tablet PC edition, which was compatible with touch-screens and supported handwriting notes on-screen.

For use in applications ATMs, industrial robots and TV set-top boxes, there was Windows XP Embedded, also called XPe. It's the same OS, but re-engineered a little to run on low-end hardware like 200 MHz processors and 32 MB of system RAM. Tempting though it might be, the license for XPe doesn't allow you to install it on a regular PC.

There's something for everyone here, and enough to keep us happy till Microsoft finally launches Windows Vista later this year.